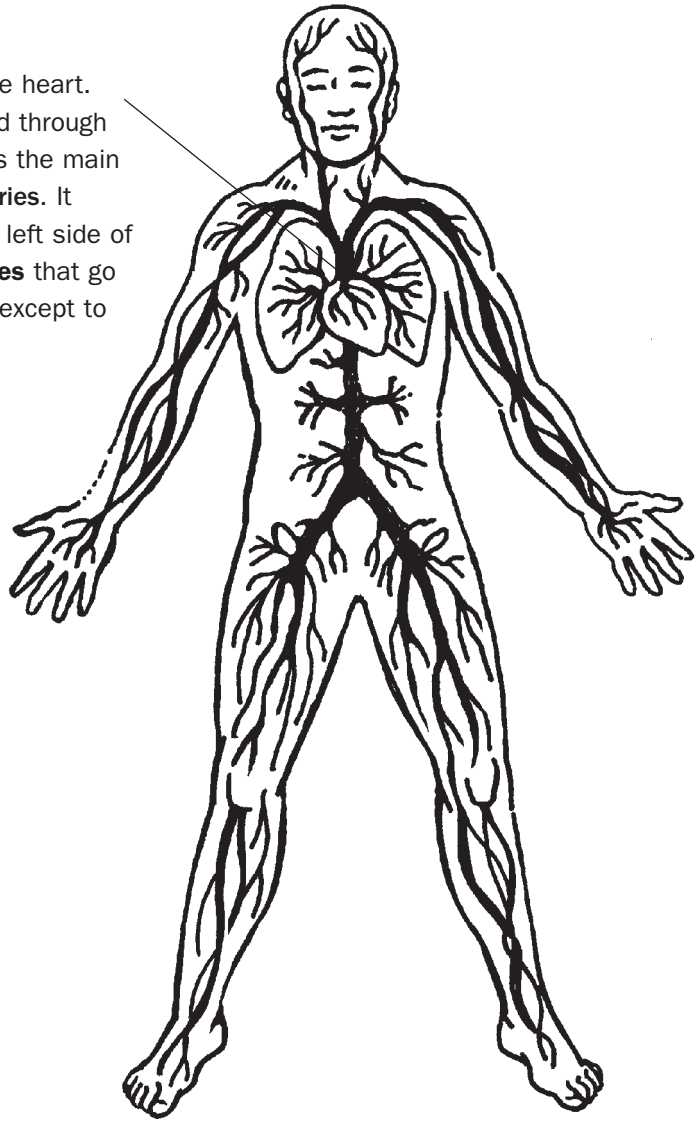
Learn Words About a New Subject

Directions As you take a journey through the circulatory system. Think about how each word in boldface connects to the big idea.

The Circulatory System

We need blood in order to survive. It gives us oxygen and nutrients. How is blood pumped and carried to the cells? That's where the circulatory system comes in! The circulatory system is made up of blood, the blood vessels, and the heart.

1 The action starts in the heart. The heart pumps blood through the **aorta**. The **aorta** is the main tube for all of the **arteries**. It carries blood from the left side of the heart to the **arteries** that go throughout the body—except to the lungs.



Vocabulary Words

aorta
artery
atrium
capillary
vein

Word Learning Tip!

When you read about a new subject, you may see new content words that you have not seen before in your everyday reading. These words are often the longest and most difficult words in the text. They tell something specific about the subject you are reading. To learn these new words, think about the big idea or subject of the paragraph. In this lesson, all content words tell about the circulatory system.

Vocabulary Building Strategy

To learn the meaning of content words that tell about a new subject, make connections between the unknown word and the big idea or subject of what you are reading. The new word will tell something specific about the big idea or subject. Tie together the big idea and the meanings of other content words that you know to determine the exact meaning of an unknown content word.

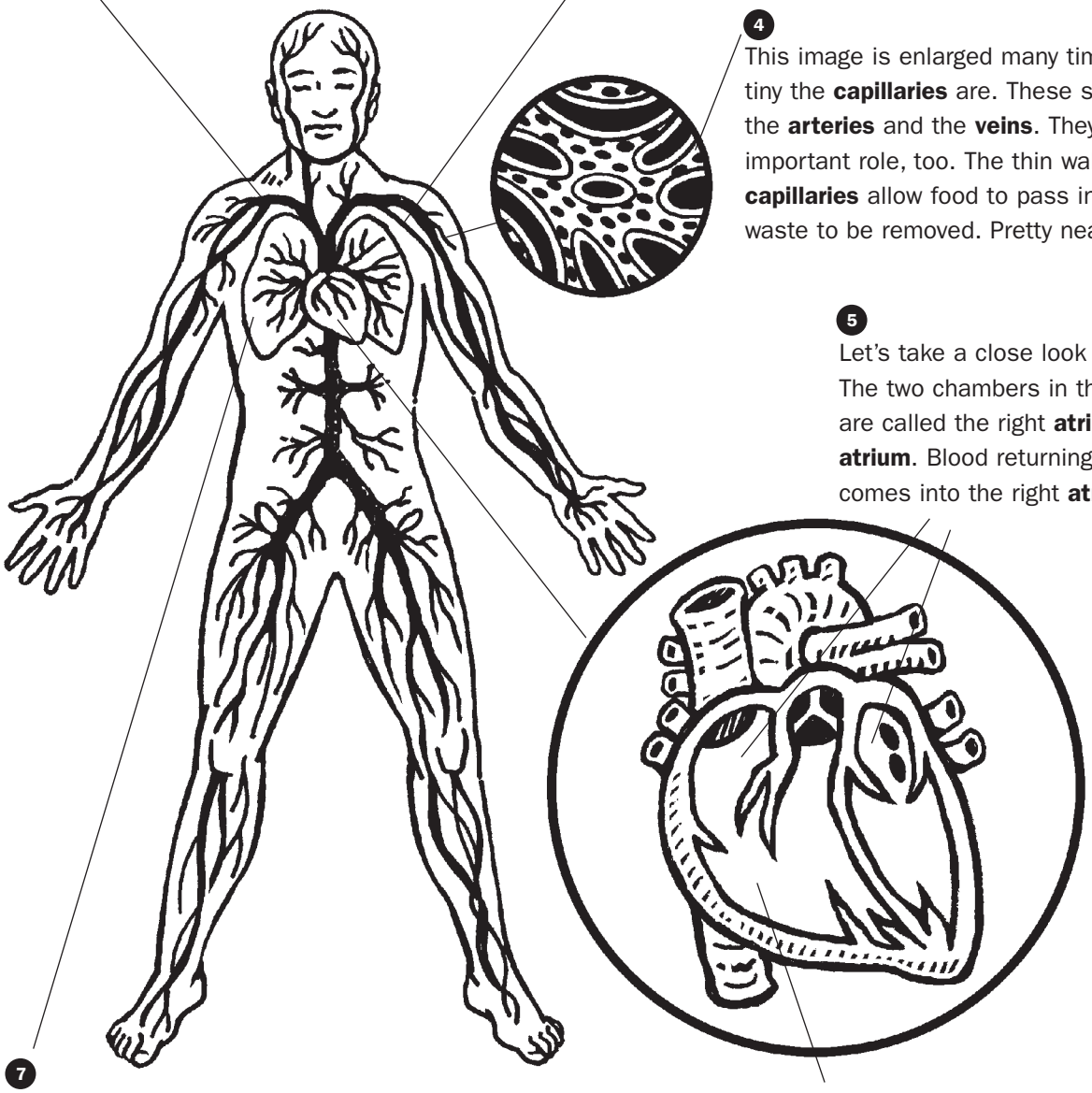
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Learn Words About a New Subject

aorta **artery** **atrium** **capillary** **vein**

2 The **arteries** are the blood vessels that carry blood away from the heart.

3 The **veins** carry blood back to the heart.



4 This image is enlarged many times. Look at how tiny the **capillaries** are. These small tubes link the **arteries** and the **veins**. They play another important role, too. The thin walls of the **capillaries** allow food to pass into the cells and waste to be removed. Pretty neat, eh?

5 Let's take a close look at the heart. The two chambers in the upper part are called the right **atrium** and the left **atrium**. Blood returning from the veins comes into the right **atrium**.

7 The blood travels from the lungs back to the heart to begin its journey again.

6 What happens to the blood then? It passes to the right ventricle. That is the chamber right below the right **atrium**. From there, it is pumped to the lungs to pick up oxygen.

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Connect Words and Meanings

aorta	artery	atrium	capillary	vein

Directions Read each definition below. In the blank next to the definition, write the vocabulary word that matches it. Then use this word to fill in the blank in the sentence.

1. **Definition** a blood vessel that carries blood away from the heart, but not the main tube

   _____

2. You can remember that an _____ carries blood *away* from the heart because both words start with *a*.

3. **Definition** the main blood vessel in the heart; the main tube for all of the arteries

   _____

4. The _____ carries blood from the heart to all parts of the body, except the lungs.

5. **Definition** either of the two chambers on both sides of the heart

   _____

6. The _____ is a powerful part of the heart that receives blood from the veins.

7. **Definition** one of the tiny tubes that carries blood between the arteries and the veins

   _____

8. You can see a tiny _____ under a microscope.

9. **Definition** a blood vessel that carries blood to the heart _____

10. You can often see a big _____ in the inside of your elbow.

Diagram the Heart Work in small groups to draw a diagram of the heart and label it. Use arrows to show how the blood moves. Use all of the vocabulary words in your diagram. Add as many new content words about the big idea as you can. Write a title for the diagram that expresses the big idea.

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Use Content Words

aorta	artery	atrium	capillary	vein

Directions Choose the vocabulary word that best fits in each sentence. Write it in the blank. You will use each word twice.

1. The heart has four chambers or rooms. One of its two upper chambers is called a(n) _____ (*atrium, capillary, vein*).
2. The circulatory system starts at the heart, which pumps blood that is filled with oxygen to the body through a large tube called the _____ (*vein, capillary, aorta*).
3. This _____ (*vein, artery, capillary*) brings blood to the spleen, which helps the body make white blood cells.
4. A(n) _____ (*vein, capillary, atrium*) is so small that you can only see it through a microscope.
5. Blood can take just one minute to travel through the _____ (*vein, aorta, capillary*) to all the blood vessels and them back to the heart.
6. White blood cells change their shape to squeeze through a narrow _____ (*atrium, artery, capillary*).
7. This leg _____ (*vein, artery, aorta*) is bringing blood back to the heart.
8. This _____ (*artery, vein capillary*) brings blood to the kidneys, which remove waste from the body.
9. Each _____ (*artery, vein, atrium*) in your arm carries blood from your arm back to the heart.
10. Blood filled with oxygen travels from the lungs to the left _____ (*atrium, aorta, artery*).

Ask Questions About the Circulatory System Imagine that you have the opportunity to interview a doctor. Write five questions you would ask the doctor about the circulatory system. Use as many vocabulary words as you can.

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Put Words Into Action

aorta	artery	atrium	capillary	vein

Directions Answer each question with one of the vocabulary words. You will use each vocabulary word twice.

1. I carry blood back to the heart. What am I? _____
2. The blood that travels through me is bright red because it is filled with oxygen. There are more than one of me carrying blood from the heart. What am I?

   _____
3. I am the largest and most important blood vessel in the heart. What am I?

   _____
4. I am the smallest blood vessel. You can't see me without help. What am I?

   _____
5. I am the part of the heart that pumps blood powerfully into the aorta. What am I?

   _____
6. You can remember that I carry blood away from the heart because I start with *a* like *away*! What am I? _____
7. I am the main blood vessel in the heart. What am I? _____
8. My name is short so I may not seem important, but I am a powerful part of the circulatory system. When doctors take blood from your arm, they look for me. What am I? _____
9. I'm an important link between blood vessels. There are over three billion of me in the body. What am I? _____
10. I am one of the two upper rooms of the heart. What am I? _____

Stage a Heart Show Work with some classmates to stage a heart show explaining the circulatory system. Some group members can write a script that describes how blood travels through the body. Be sure to use vocabulary words as often as you can. You should use the heart diagram that you made earlier in this lesson in your show. Act out the script for your classmates.

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Review and Extend

aorta	artery	atrium	capillary	vein

Bonus Words Here are three new words about the big idea of this lesson, the circulatory system. Since all the words are about the same big idea, you can connect each word to this subject to learn its specific meaning.

blood vessel	one of the many veins and arteries that carry blood through the body
chamber	an enclosed space in the heart
circulate	the way blood moves through the body; to move in a regular way

Directions Read each sentence below. Choose the vocabulary word or the new content word that best completes each sentence. Write the word in the blank. Use each word only once.

1. A _____ can be so small that blood cells have to pass through one at a time, in a straight line.

2. The heart has four parts. Each part of the heart is called a(n) _____.

3. The _____ is the main blood vessel in the heart.

4. The heart pumps blood so it can _____ throughout the body, bringing food and removing wastes.

5. An artery is a _____; so is a vein and a capillary!

Bonus Write a sentence about the circulatory system that uses two of your vocabulary words.

_____



Keep Your Heart Healthy Think about why it is important to keep your heart healthy. Why do you think that diet and exercise are important? Use as many vocabulary words as you can to answer this question.

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Check Your Mastery

Directions Read each item below. Then circle the letter of the vocabulary word that best completes each sentence.

1. A blood vessel that carries blood away from the heart is the _____.
A. vein **B.** artery **C.** atrium

2. A(n) _____ is such a small blood vessel that blood cells have to travel through it in a single row.
A. aorta **B.** atrium **C.** capillary

3. The _____ sends oxygen-rich blood to all parts of the body, except the lungs.
A. vein **B.** atrium **C.** aorta

4. The _____ is one of the upper chambers of the heart.
A. atrium **B.** artery **C.** aorta

5. A(n) _____ carries blood that has circulated through the body back to the heart.
A. artery **B.** vein **C.** atrium

6. An _____ carries blood away from the heart. The body has many of these blood vessels, not just one.
A. artery **B.** atrium **C.** aorta

7. This blood vessel, a _____, moves blood back to the heart.
A. vein **B.** capillary **C.** aorta

8. After blood travels to the lungs to receive oxygen, it returns to the left _____.
A. artery **B.** vein **C.** atrium

9. A tiny blood vessel that joins the arteries and the veins is called a(n) _____.
A. aorta **B.** capillary **C.** atrium

10. The _____ is the main artery in the body.
A. aorta **B.** capillary **C.** vein

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